Founder CRM + Task Management - Project Brief

Team 4: Krishna & Vaishnavi

🎯 The Problem

Startup founders juggle too much: customer conversations, feature requests, team tasks, investor follow-ups, product roadmap. Everything is scattered across emails, WhatsApp, notebooks.

Your Mission: Build a simple CRM and task manager designed specifically for early-stage founders and small startup teams.

✅ Must Have (Core Features)

1. Basic Auth + Team

- Founders register and create workspace
- Invite team members
- Simple roles (Founder, Team Member)

2. Contact Management (CRM)

- Add contacts (customers, investors, partners)
- Store basic info: name, email, company, type (customer/investor/partner)
- Add notes to each contact
- Track conversations and interactions
- Tag contacts (lead, active customer, churned, hot lead, etc.)

3. Task Management

- Create tasks
- Assign to team members
- Set due dates and priority

- Mark as complete
- Link tasks to contacts (e.g., "Follow up with Customer X")
- Categories: Sales, Product, Operations, Fundraising, etc.

4. Pipeline/Deal Tracking

- Track deals/sales opportunities
- Stages: Lead → Qualified → Demo → Proposal → Closed
- Drag and drop between stages
- Associate with contacts

5. Simple Dashboard

- Today's tasks
- Upcoming deadlines
- Recent contact interactions
- Deal pipeline overview
- Quick add buttons

🎨 Your Creative Freedom

You Decide:

- How to organize information
- UI/UX design and workflows
- What fields to track
- How to visualize pipeline
- Mobile vs desktop focus
- Notification system

Go Beyond (Optional Ideas):

- Email integration (sync Gmail)
- Calendar view for tasks
- Activity timeline for each contact

- Deal value tracking & revenue forecasting
- Team collaboration (comments, mentions)
- File attachments
- WhatsApp/Slack integration
- Reminders and notifications
- Search and filters
- Custom fields
- Import/export contacts
- Analytics dashboard
- Meeting notes
- Product feedback tracking

🤖 AI Integration (Required)

Minimum: AI helps organize and prioritize

Ideas to Explore:

- Auto-summarize long notes/conversations
- Suggest follow-up actions based on last interaction
- Prioritize tasks based on urgency and context
- Categorize contacts automatically
- Draft follow-up emails
- Predict which leads are likely to convert
- Suggest next steps in sales process
- Generate meeting summaries
- Smart search across all data

Example AI Features:

```
After adding note: "Had call with investor, interested but
wants to see traction"
```

```
AI suggests:
- Create task: "Share metrics deck with [investor name]"
- Set reminder: "Follow up in 1 week"
- Tag: "Hot lead - Needs traction proof"
```

AI Tools: OpenAI, Gemini, Claude

💡 Founder-Specific Features

Think about what founders actually need:

- Quick capture (add things fast!)
- See what matters TODAY
- Track who they talked to and when
- Remember what they promised customers
- Don't let leads go cold
- Know what the team is working on
- Simple, not enterprise complex

This is NOT Salesforce!

- Keep it simple
- Fast to use
- Focused on early-stage needs
- Not trying to do everything

📦 What to Submit

1. Working App

- Deployed URL
- All core features work
- Can be used by a real startup

2. Documentation

- **README.md:** What it does, how to use it

- **Postman Collection:** API docs
- User guide (how founders should use it)

3. Marketing Stuff

- Product Hunt launch plan
- Screenshots
- Demo video (show actual workflow)
- "Use case" examples

💡 Quick Tips

Start Simple:

1. Build auth + workspace
2. Add contacts CRUD
3. Add tasks CRUD
4. Link tasks to contacts
5. Build dashboard
6. Add pipeline/deals
7. Integrate AI for smart features

Test With Real Scenario:
Imagine you're a founder with:

- 5 customer leads
- 3 active customers
- 2 investors to follow up with
- 10 tasks for the week
- 2 team members

Can your tool handle this smoothly?

Tech Suggestions:

- Frontend: React, Vue, or Next.js
- Backend: Node.js, Python, anything

- Database: PostgreSQL (relational data works well here)
- Real-time: WebSockets for live updates
- AI: OpenAI, Gemini, Claude

Focus On:

- Speed (quick capture, quick view)
- Clarity (see what matters now)
- Simplicity (not overwhelming)
- Usefulness (actually helps founders)

⏰ Timeline: 7 Days

Suggested Breakdown:

- Days 1-2: Auth + contacts + basic UI
- Days 3-4: Tasks + linking + pipeline
- Day 5: AI features + dashboard
- Day 6: Deploy + documentation
- Day 7: Marketing + demo

🎨 UI Inspiration

Think:

- Linear (task management)
- Notion (flexible, clean)
- Pipedrive (simple CRM)
- NOT Salesforce (too complex)

Keep it minimal and fast!

✨ What Makes This Great

Your project stands out if:

- A real founder would actually use it

- It's faster than using spreadsheets
- AI genuinely helps (not just gimmick)
- UI is clean and uncluttered
- You can demo a realistic workflow
- Solves real founder pain points

📋 Real Founder Workflows to Support

Morning routine:

- Check today's tasks
- See who to follow up with
- Review hot leads

After customer call:

- Quick note capture
- Create follow-up task
- Update deal stage

End of week:

- Review what got done
- Plan next week
- Check pipeline health

Make these flows smooth!

Remember: Founders need simple, fast tools. Not enterprise complexity. Focus on solving real daily problems for early-stage founders.

Good luck! 💼